

## Pick Littlefield To Open Series

**Crafty Southpaw  
Has 9-1 Posting**

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Wichita and San Francisco are miles apart but they're closer than spendthrifts on one miserable little item that harks of "staggering proportions:" both cities' ballteams are hoping to rebound from the reeling that has set in of late.

It was scarcely more than a week back that the Giants of the Bay City dreamed mightily of extra dividends, like say harvested from a World Series loot-fall. That was before Manager Bill Rigney's proud and perky personalities hove into close-up view of the Milwaukee Braves. What happened there shouldn't happen, Giants fans are in unanimous agreement. But it did. The San Franciscans sneaked out of the suds capital muttering to themselves. What had been a dead heat turned into a seared Goliath. The Giants found themselves five games back, and their still stumbling.

Now, Wichita's Braves pose a similar situation. When Denver's second place Bears came to town in midweek, Manager Ben Geraghty's Wichitas dreamed of overtaking the Bruins and snatching the runnerup spot all for themselves. While they were dreaming, the Bears snapped out of a previously enforced hibernation caused by rainouts and smacked the Braves right back on their kissers.

You will recall the Braves had just dealt handsomely with those upstart Millers from Minneapolis, both here and up in the north country. The Geraghtymen found themselves in third place before you could say Andy Cohen. Apparently Cohen heard about this slight and remedied the affront when he led his Bears here earlier this week. In any event his underlings knocked off the Braves three straight times. That settled that second base matter—for the time.

Now the time has come, avers Geraghty, for his Braves to do a little dirty work in this matter of who wins and who loses. He figures his tribesmen just might start with Omaha's Cardinals who arrived in town earlier today. He couldn't have picked a better team to unveil the "new look" against—the Cards have only beaten Wichita 10 out of 14 so far this season.

The Wichita-Omaha have-at-ft tonight, at 8 o'clock, keynotes a four-game series that lasts through Monday. A doubleheader is scheduled Sunday.

For the opener, Geraghty will send his top percentage pitcher, Dick Littlefield, against Omaha's Bob Blaylock. The lefty Littlefield sports a gaudy 9-1 won-lost record; Blaylock is 6-10. In his only previous start against the Cards, Littlefield wasn't around at the finish and thus posted a no-decision effort.

He hopes to improve that standing tonight.

Barring further rain, the Braves management anticipates a rather nice turnout which will be enhanced by some 2,000 YMCA Small Fry League rooters. Tomorrow night, between games, Lawrence Stadium will reverberate with songs of the Gay '90s and sundry other ditties sung by the Wichita Barbershop Chorus. The harmonizers should attract scads of music-loving baseball fans. Then, on Monday night the extra-curricular doings picks up a mite of pulchritude when the 1958 Miss Kansas comes in to present All Star Game awards to Braves' participant - inners. That ought to really bring 'em out, thinks Braves General Manager Lynn Stone.